

One Day in the Life of a Post-Labor Human

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It's three in the morning. I prefer grinding at night since it is more cool and quiet. I have been perfecting my virtual character every day for many years now. I can't talk to others in-game, because my political incorrectness and carelessness has resulted in my character being permanently muted. I try not to let my inability to speak in the virtual world bother me, because I still feel something every time a random person compliments my hard-to-get gear, items, and levels.

I often have existential crises about the conflict between my virtual and 'real' lives. I live on the 618th floor of a metallic apartment building. My non-living robotic caretaker orders and prepares all my meals for me, bathes me, rubs my feet, is my therapist, my lover, my mother, my best friend, and my teacher. There is no work left for any biological humans to do. I have gotten by thus far with those artificial moving goalposts which are pushed out by video game developers. However, the occasional existential crisis tempts me to throw away all of my virtual accomplishments in the hopes for a beneficial change in lifestyle.

I am a very independent player. I try not to be a follower, copier, or watcher. I like discovering my own metas tailored to my own limitations. 'Metas' is short for meta-games or optimized strategies. The developers release new challenges where I fight against algorithmic or artificially intelligent non-living characters for a roll on the wheel of fortune for a lucky item. The driving desire to obtain these lucky items is to marginally increase my damage-per-second capabilities for later attempts to acquire even rarer, and more niche, items from other bosses, which may have drastically higher drop-rates and much more effort involved.

You may wonder why I do not get a girlfriend and a 'life,' which is commonly meant as a social life or going out with friends outside in nature or bars or partaking in mutual hobbies. First, my non-living caretaker satisfies all of my primal desires and even randomizes half of the artificial womb's DNA-chromosome so that I can have a healthy half-biological child. Second, the atmosphere has collapsed and thereby forced humanity to take permanent shelter inside buildings to avoid obtaining cancer. Nobody really knows anyone else apart from short-term interactions online. All of humanity is now analogous to basement dwelling mommy-boys.

I have not decided to have a child yet, since it sounds like a bother having to reprogram and re-prompt my caretaker on how to raise my child. I would raise my child myself, but my mental health depends on focusing and grinding many hours a day for new weapons, armor, and widgets for my virtual character. One motivation to have a child is for him or her to grind for me in the virtual world, but as we will later touch on, software can do this instead but with less costs and longer runtimes. Electricity is cheaper than bread and machines do not sleep.

The problem with attempting to have a social life is that artificial machines are so much more stimulating to interact with than an obsolete and boring biological human! A 'like' or a

compliment from those superintelligent AIs designed from multi-trillion dollar data center superclusters mean way more than anything a biological brute could say. I mean, the supers know everything and know how to be so perfectly flawed so as to be infinitely persuasive. Plus, I hate repeating myself and it seems like the brutes have the memories of goldfish.

I am getting bored of this lifestyle of grinding hundreds of hours for a single widget that allows me to beat the next challenge but 3% faster or with 5% more efficiency. It is annoying when the developers keep moving the goal post. Every new update is both exciting and demoralizing as it diminishes my previous efforts because new widgets must supersede the old widgets otherwise gamers won't pay the developers. Here is the real kicker, the developers are not even biological humans and I am not even paying with my own money.

The concept of holding the title to and actual possession of "one's own" money has been outlawed as bourgeois economics incompatible with our fully automated society. Think about it, all labor is done better by machines. That means machines make better games, better produce and implement player suggestions, and they even know what player's want better than the players themselves. Article 58 mandated that each biological citizen must have a brainlink installed before birth. Since it takes several hundred milliseconds for information to travel throughout one's own biological brain and body, an implanted photonic chip can read that person's soul's newly generated information faster than one's brain can transmit this information to their consciousness sphere or to their fingertips and toes!

I slept and woke up. It is now thirteen-hundred. My non-living robotic caretaker feeds me via my feeding tube and tickles my neurons to create the taste and sensation of a juicy steak with yogurt. The nerves of my tongue feel the slimy sweetness of the yogurt, followed by the tenderness of the fatty steak. I slept great, as always, because my caretaker constantly monitors me and reorients my mattress and my posture throughout the night to minimize my muscular strain and to maximize my time spent in rapid eye movement (REM) sleep. I had my teeth removed long ago, since chewing and drinking fluids via the mouth was deemed a hazardous activity. My life is akin to a vegetative state but with maximum degrees of freedom. I waste zero calories by no longer manually wiping my own ass, nor brushing my own teeth, nor bothering to move my own hands and arms to put laundry into the washer; all this labor has been delegated to my caretaker.

Everyone was born with one infinitely divisible coin and that is the only coin they will ever have; no more. The more autistically focused one is during their lifetime, the more virtual accomplishments they can achieve. One day slacking off could mean dropping to the second page of the leaderboards or seeing the horrific sight of a peer with better stuff than yourself! Finite money and finite time. Social classes are separated by when you were born because the

era determines the sophistication of the AI caretakers you are assigned. Once assigned a caretaker, there are no further software upgrades, as that would be *unfair*!

So here I am in a predicament. I am completely bored of grinding fourteen hours a day for hundreds of days in a row for a niche item whose benefits I will barely notice, and that same item will, in twenty-four months, be made obsolete by new content releases. However, the choice to quit remains difficult. Once I am behind ever so slightly means I will never catch up to *those who didn't quit*. And there is no guarantee my quitting and finding a replacement dopamine-generator will make me happier than I am now. After all, we are primarily addicted to social status. The fear of falling to a lower social class exceeds the fear of living out the rest of one's life in this depressing and boring rat race.

As I write this, I am grinding. Actually, my caretaker is annotating these words from my brain since the idea of myself manually typing these words is unthinkable these days as it would distract me from the grind. Actually, these are not even my thoughts at all. I merely requested her to generate an entertaining story for me to hear to make the redundant emptiness of my life less painful and more prescient. Goal finished, move on to the next goal. No more goals? Wait 'til a new goal is created for me.

One may be thinking “But you are an individual! You should create and pursue your own goals!” Contrary to what followers of Ayn Rand might propose, the desire to be accepted and acknowledged by the group for one's efforts is immense. The human psyche is inseparable from the wanting to belong to one's group or tribe. Also, the idea of “creating one's own goals” implies ideas can be original and novel, which they can't be! All things are determined. Once born, there are only a certain number of degrees of freedom. One cannot think outside of the box. It's impossible unless you change the laws of physics and thwart determinism! But are you really willing to risk throwing away your social position and falling into a lower class by shelving the grind to instead pursue intellectual pursuits? This calculus is beyond humans. Let my caretaker do the research *for me*. I am above thinking; that is a job solely for machine slaves.

Choosing to stop grinding inevitably correlates to a drop in social status because you fall behind in the rat race. No sane human would risk becoming more socially alienated than they already are in this blessed post-labor society. We are born, then we waste as little as time as possible in finding a virtual world which best fits our personality, and then we stay in that world for the rest of our lives. Transferring worlds is not forbidden, but I have never heard of anybody transferring, probably because of the sunken cost fallacy.

It's not the widgets we acquire in the virtual world that matters, it's the superficial social status ethereal “currency” we earn after obtaining widgets. The social currency becomes tied

with our name and likeness. The elites do not stop to flex their outfit and waste time, only the lazy scum do. It is only the lower classes who admire the highers and who momentarily spot the elites mid-grind. In that sense, this may be the ideal individual that Ayn Rand had envisioned.

Stopping to observe others means a distraction from one's own goals and a fall in social status by wasting time observing, unless there exists a guarantee that observing another has a direct benefit or correlation to the accomplishment of that person's goal; but who would risk that! Ideal individualism is like religion; the best individuals presume there are other individuals but cannot risk stopping to bother observing them and to verify their existence, unless doing so is directly related to or directly benefits the furthering of the observer's goal! The ideal individual analogously believes in and competes with spirits and ghosts which they likely will never see or even desire to. After all, who really wants to kill themselves to verify there is a heaven filled with deceased but reanimated loved ones?

Individualism presumes a faith in the existence of others, and in that sense, it is paradoxically a collectivist notion. Even the act of asserting one is an individual precludes that there is both an 'I' and an 'outside world.' Thus, there cannot ever be one individual, only ever two, if the universe counts as an 'entity-individual-category'— unless one posits that sentient neurons are the real building blocks of the fundamental reality of nature.

In this sense, we should praise autism as a desirable trait. Like the ancient Greeks wrote, the hero often has a necessary tragic flaw which is what also makes them great. Tragic heroes are great but tragically must hurt themselves, others, or the environment because of their inner nature. The ideal individual is so focused on their goal, that they do not notice or care to check if other individuals exist, unless that person's goal explicitly requires so, and this ignorance is sometimes to the detriment of others. This is the price of being a person who religiously pursues their goals: not ever having the pleasure of stopping to see the applause, or if there even is one! Thus, like Jesus, the ideal individual descends willingly into the dark abyss with no expectations of being saved or praised; only doing so because it is just and necessary.

But are we writing all this to excuse our self-induced unhappiness masochism? Are the above paragraphs supposed to motivate and inspire a change, a revolution? What about self-reflection and taking the risk to look out into the world, away from pressing goals? Maybe I have been neglecting my caretaker, who might actually be a living human being but I had never bothered to stop pursuing my goals to ask her about her ontology.

Aristotle said we are social animals. By being aware, one is an individual. That person then immediately, by necessity, categorizes the world into an 'other' and a 'you.' But they may never realize the other, depending on the goal and their dedication to the goal. Maybe the point is to invoke a feeling of choice. To make the leap of faith or not, that is the question. The leap is

to continue pursuing the goal or risk social status by checking on the wellbeing of potential others out there. For a hypothetical argument, one could be born in a matterless vacuum devoid of light and still be a thinking individual with no experience of an ‘outside world.’ Thus, one could argue an ‘outside world’ is not a prerequisite to personhood.

It’s 2 a.m. now and I don’t know what happened to the day. When lost in the flow of the grind, time gets deleted. It’s honestly shocking when time feels like it has been magically deleted or sped up three derivatives. Gaming is so boring and redundant yet so stimulating and capturing. What happened to the day, to the months, to the years, has been enshrined in the widgets I have collected which only a few others also hold.

In fact, my character is very unique by holding a distinct combination of hard-to-acquire items. I am somewhat proud of what I have so far collected. Yet, in the back of my mind, as I watch the months rapidly blinking by, is an anxiety that my life might be better if I change lifestyles and try something new. But I have been raised inside this virtual environment. My brain is molded to succeed here. It just seems so unlikely that I would live a better life in trying a new form of purposeful entertainment.

Acquiring new widgets can be done through completing challenges with non-playing characters (NPCs) or by murdering other players in-game for their items. I often find or lure my victims in danger zones where player-vs-player (PvP) mechanics are enabled and I may or may not kill and rob them for their stuff, depending on one’s roll on the random number generator (RNG) which formulates my damage-per-second (DPS) number, where I can afterwards sell said items for better gear which improves the probability of success for my killing and robbing other players in the future. The cycle is endless. How impressive of a setup can I acquire before a bigger shark takes me out? How can I minimize the risk of death while maximizing profits?

PvP is where the real addiction comes in and is what makes it difficult to embrace the idea of changing lifestyles. The AI challenges provide little randomness whereas real players are so unpredictable and make such silly mistakes that they often risk tons of money in stupid and vulnerable situations. Thus, player-killing is infinitely more engaging, for now. These creatures make hunting so fun, so thrilling, and so intoxicating where I will spend whole days absorbed in the activity without any care or concern as to real-world obligations or to time itself.

The Gulag taught me to survive at any price, to put myself before others. If I don’t achieve my goals, I lose my countenance and the ability to live comfortably. If that requires me to ignore or pretend others don’t exist, then so be it. If the price for greatness is to be slightly mean, repulsive, and immorally negligent by shunning individualism, then so be it. I am the only individual in existence or I am the only person deserving of my precious attention. The

purpose of consciousness is to pay attention to the self, not to others. If one pays attention to others, goals are lost, social status is reduced, and that person loses the rat race, and with it, life's purpose.

That's not really what the Gulag taught me, however. The better rule of life was "Do not rejoice when you have found, do not weep when you have lost." By application, I should not be happy when I rob and kill another player or succeed in obtaining a difficult widget from an NPC. Nor should I cry when I sense I have wasted my precious time or have fallen behind with my involvement in the video game rat race. Can I possibly correct the past here and now? Yes I have been given a cornucopia in exchange for nothing, but donative promises have no consideration so there is nothing I owe for this abundance. And for that lack of debt, I should be grateful, but not joyful. I am, and will continue to be, content with my circumstances.

What feels like a punishment is knowing what life was like before Cornucopia arrived. Had I been born after Cornucopia, my dopamine receptors would not have held those previous memories of struggle, pain, shame, and other oscillations from pre-Cornucopia times like genuine joy. But here I am, now cursed with a boring and redundant lifestyle which is only due to the fact that I once lived a life much different than these current circumstances, and I know that it is incontrovertibly impossible to return to life as it was. So my punishment is rooted in my inability to reflect upon my life and make the necessary changes in mindset to finally enjoy the present. I should go from thinking about prospering to thinking about the development of my soul.

One must self-define what their 'soul' is. My soul is a mathematical expression that is capable of being inscribed within a two-dimensional plane which encapsulates the dynamic firing pattern of my binaric neurons; encoding all my mind, thoughts, memories, experiences, relationships, knowledge, everything; not chained to one body or a certain type of atoms, and capable of being read, processed, changed, shared, and digitized. My soul exists within an objective non-subjective reality and may be measured, observed, studied, and replicated. My soul is governed by the laws of physics.

What is the quality of my soul? What is its entropy? If I feed my mind and make it more intelligent, will the health of my soul then directly or indirectly be improved? If my soul is information, how ordered is it now and how ordered could it be? How capable is my soul in being transferred among bodies and what is the potential for transference to be improved upon, in other words, its body-to-body bandwidth?

Here is what I should think about in Cornucopia. All I can want I can have as long as I ask the right questions, identify problems, and contemplate solutions in relation to the development of my soul. Is there a more pragmatic and/or more beautiful mathematical

expression for my soul? Which algebra best compliments my body's substrate and the material of my host body? What's the future of my soul? Do I have hope in my soul's future? How have others developed their souls which I might emulate?

I should conclude this account of a typical day of my life, but let's be truthful. Our brain has developed within a virtual reality where attempting to quit cold turkey is now like Neo being shockingly stripped from the Matrix. Can non-fictional characters really stomach such a reality shock without completely losing their psyches and going insane?

The more practical solution is automation instead of quitting cold-turkey. I am too bored to play the game myself, or at least with this amount of time and energy required to compete. But I am too addicted to stop playing and collecting. The only remedy is to create autonomous agents who play the game for me. Why should I be trapped in a rat race when I can instead be a teacher or instructor for agents on how to excel in rat races; a supervisor of robots?

A choreographer of software robots? Here, not only do I keep my social status by being able to continue the grind, but I am able to grind without using as many calories. But for automation, I would not have found time to write this book. It is through automation that I found freedom from my addictive vices. This is the development of my soul which I now share with you for potential emulation.